



Cycling ka asli mazaa

MOBILISING INDIA

Excellent quality, economical price and ethical business dealings have enabled the Avon Group of Ludhiana occupy a unique position in the bicycle industry.

Avon is a well-known name in the international bicycle market. With full backward integration, high-class technology, reasonable price, consistent quality and effective after-sales service, Avon has remained in the top performers' position for over half a century.

The Pahwa Brothers started a bicycle saddles and brakes manufacturing unit in Ludhiana in 1948. Gradually, their dream of giving the common man of India an affordable means of mobility in the early days of Independence led to the

introduction of Avon Cycles in Indian markets in 1952. The first batch rolled out 250 bicycles out of its plant. The numbers have been on the rise ever since in India and abroad.

The most remarkable feature of Avon Cycles that makes it so hard-wearing and durable is that this is the only group in the world that has full backward integration facilities. Except for tyre and tubes, which are a different discipline altogether, Avon has facilities for making almost all bicycle parts, including steel balls, steel strips, steel tubes and hot rolled steel.

Today, Avon distinguishes itself as the Largest Manufacturer Exporter from India in bicycles and bicycle parts — an Export House recognised by the Government of India.

WIDE RANGE OF BICYCLES

Avon has one bicycle made for each one of us! From the starry-eyed urge of the tiny toddler reaching for his first pedals, all the way up to the excitement and thrill of a 21-speed MTB, there is one made just right for each one. Commuting, touring, transport, adventure, fun and sport, vending/delivery operations, physical fitness, group pursuits, and lots more, the machine's capability to perform anywhere out of nowhere allows it an unimaginable number of applications.

There is a lot involved in making this wide array of bicycles well-suited for customer-specific needs. Let's take a quick look at the interesting production process of Avon Cycles.

LEADING THE TEAM

The team works under the able leadership of Chairman and Managing Director, Onkar Singh Pahwa. His elder son, Rishi Pahwa is Director - Purchases and Works. The younger son, Mandeep Pahwa is Director - Sales and Finance. A hierarchy of senior Vice Presidents, Vice Presidents and General Managers heads various functions.

ENSURING QUALITY PRODUCTION

From research and development, planning, human resource and quality management to manufacturing products that exceed the expectations of customers, the Avon Group is earnestly involved in every stage of bicycle manufacturing process.

A continuous modification of product designs as per changing trends plays a vital role in beating outside competition. The product planning division sets realistic goals and finds ways to achieve them. The control department keeps a check on the management activities to ensure that all actions are consistent with the stated goals.

EFFICIENT MARKETING

Wide choice, updated quality, affordable price, streamlined distribution and an appealing message form the marketing philosophy of Avon Cycle Limited. To make sure that each Avon product is an ideal Value For Money (VFM) proposition, the company plays a proactive role to determine level of satisfaction and also to understand the changing consumer aspirations.

With their honest policies and just dealings, the promoters have built enduring business bonds with a vast dealer network in India and abroad. Inland distribution is done through a well-established network of about 1,600 Avon authorised dealers in various cities and towns of India. A dedicated resource of more than 12,000 sub-dealers supports operations of the dealership. Overseas operations are conducted through representatives in the concerned countries/regions.

At home in 85 countries worldwide, the company's products are regularly showcased in International Trade Fairs and Exhibitions.

A number of reputed transporters and haulers on a sub-contracting basis are employed by the company so as to ensure safe and speedy delivery to the dealership points spread across the length and breadth of the country. In addition, for multiple delivery point trips, the company's accompanying attendants ensure correct and proper delivery. Many of the company's dealers have grown into the second and even third generation of owners.

IDEAL WORK ENVIRONMENT

Clean, congenial and commensurate environment in the company keeps the work force motivated. Workers' participation in goal setting makes them exceptionally self-driven. Recruitment and training hinges on the principle of right man for the

